***ACTIVITY 5***

# Evaluate Evidence and Write Audit Findings

ISO 9001 Quality Management System (QMS) Internal Auditor Training
TGS-2023039341 · K2 · K3 · A2 · LO2 · 75 minutes

## Objective

Analyse sampled evidence, identify compliance gaps and write precise, traceable findings.

## Scenario

The audit team sampled supplier approval, competence, calibration, drawing control and complaint handling. Some records show clear fulfilment, some show isolated anomalies, and others are incomplete. Management asks the team to avoid both overstatement and vague findings.

## Materials

- Twelve evidence cards in the activity PDF
- Requirement-intent and finding decision guide
- Findings log with completeness checks

## Activity questions

- Which evidence is sufficient and relevant to the audit criteria?
- Which items show a confirmed non-fulfilment, and which need more evidence?
- How should the significance be described without replacing the organisation's grading rules?
- Does each finding allow a reader to reconstruct the evidence trail?

## Required evidence

- Evidence evaluation log
- Finding statements
- Classification rationale
- Calibration notes

## Detailed Procedure

**1.** Read each evidence card and record only the facts that can be verified.

**2.** Link each evidence item to the relevant process control and requirement intent.

**3.** Classify the provisional outcome as conformity, possible nonconformity, confirmed nonconformity, opportunity for improvement or insufficient evidence.

**4.** For each possible nonconformity, identify what additional evidence would confirm or refute the gap.

**5.** Write confirmed findings using four elements: requirement, objective evidence, concise statement of non-fulfilment and affected process/risk.

**6.** Avoid blame, causes not yet proven, unsupported adjectives and prescribed solutions.

**7.** Apply the organisation's finding classification criteria consistently; record the rationale separately from the factual statement.

**8.** Use the quality checklist to test traceability, neutrality, completeness and readability.

**9.** Conduct a calibration discussion: compare two teams' classifications and resolve differences using criteria and evidence.

## Acceptance Check

Every nonconformity identifies a requirement and verifiable evidence; no finding contains an unproven cause or a mandatory solution; insufficient evidence is explicitly flagged.

## Learner completion checklist

| Done | Evidence / output | Reviewer comment |
|---|---|---|
| ■ | Evidence evaluation log | |
| ■ | Finding statements | |
| ■ | Classification rationale | |
| ■ | Calibration notes | |